

VENUS FLYTRAP

Dionaea muscipula

Few plants have had pencils probed into them as often as this one. The Venus flytrap is every school child's dream. And the magnificent blood-red throat, green stems, and outer lashes are every fly's nightmare. A plant with such a strong personality is sure to engage your mind.

“I’m a lovable monster who’ll eat your flies!”

Help me thrive



POSITION

Does best in a brightly lit spot but can tolerate partial shade. Avoid putting them in direct sunlight since they may burn up.



POTTING

Can be grown in a pot with drainage holes or in a terrarium with gravel underneath. A mix of sand and sphagnum moss is best for drainage.



GROWTH RATE

These are slow-growing plants, reaching a maximum height of only 1ft (30cm) and a width of 6in (15cm) over a period of several years.



CARE

In summer, stand in a saucer of rainwater or distilled water. In winter, keep the soil moist. They don't need fertilizer as they get nutrients from flies.



I will fascinate you

There are few plants that will fill you with more awe than I will when you see me eating my prey. The hairlike structures on my leaves can sense the presence of insects, and I respond by snapping my jaws shut. I then secrete digestive juices to consume them.

